

COBWEBBED PORCELAIN

Freeze seeps

three
inches
into
glacial
soil..

Crystals burst

like
young
yeast.

Dandruff falls

from
the
sky—
tracing
the
path
back.

The poles converge.

Birds
withdraw.

Snow condenses

to
drops—
to
silicon
seeds.

Cryonic
sleep.
Peroxide
spreads.

White doves.

White
storks.
White
swans.

Titanium oxide,

Sodium
carbonate,
Potassium
chloride—
gossamer
frostwork.

Exhausted photons.

Glass stalactites.

Stone
lightning.

Nature—

a
reprint
that
fades
faster
than
the
original,
vanishing
in
cobwebbed
porcelain.

ROMANCE IN FRAGMENTS

Shade the beast within—

adorn yourself
with runes,
ancient,
aligned.

Making love with half your body;

sweat creases the cotton
into silk,
into silvered silk.

Intimacy refines its toxins;

shoulders widen beneath tenderness,
bending,
bonding.

Again you wound yourself

for too little return,
too fragile
to forget.

Cold air envelops us;

the flat breathing scents around you—
faint,
fading.

Anonymous favorites linger,
 corrupting the air;
 even silence stutters,
 stalls,
 sighs
 and settles.
Through the morning window:
 blackbirds,
 one-winged,
 flying in pairs,
 leaning,
 lifting.
First light crosses the ceiling—
 an apostrophe of gold,
 a promise,
 a pulse,
 a prayer of dawn.
Chains of the Rosary clatter across Eden,
 a swarm of idols—
thus martyrs are born.

A SUMMER DAY NEAR 45 DEGREES LATITUDE

45° latitude. The heat conserves everything.
Faces waver in hot-warped glass; the street exhales a low hum, afternoon folding over
itself.
Air thickens. Fumes slice it like agar plates. Bacteria flourish—exotic, resistant,
untroubled by centuries.
Gravel roads rise in dust faster than yesterday's papers. From above they read as

obsolete barcodes—the sky scans them with no interest.
Photons drift through gas, grazing stale air along the façades.
Here you first glimpsed quanta dripping like molten crystals from the glare of light.
Silhouettes crawl skyward; clouds break—the cyclone's center twists the horizon into
twin vortices.
Your breath presses the air; the atmosphere folds inward—thin turbulence stretching
across distance, measurable only as a polynomial's curve.
Triple point of no return.

Even water learns to ferment.